

Kaizen Champion Development Program

Developing internal improvement leaders for manufacturing operations

BRIEF INTRODUCTION

This program is designed to develop internal Kaizen Champions who can identify operational waste, structure improvement work, and support practical follow-through on the factory floor. Participants will learn how to frame real workplace problems, use simple but disciplined improvement tools, and prepare an A3-based action plan that can be reviewed with management after the program.

Practical

Workplace problem framing

Structured

PDCA, root cause and A3 thinking

Sustainable

Follow-through and ownership mindset

COURSE OBJECTIVES

What the Program Is Designed to Build

The objectives focus on practical improvement ownership: seeing the problem clearly, analysing it with discipline, and preparing action that can be followed through at work.

Champion Role

Understand the role of a Kaizen Champion in supporting continuous improvement and practical workplace ownership.

Waste Identification

Identify waste, recurring problems, and operational losses in daily manufacturing work.

Structured Problem Solving

Apply PDCA, 5 Why, Fishbone, and 7QC tools to analyse real workplace problems.

Business Impact

Use QCD thinking to connect improvement activity with quality, cost, delivery, and management priorities.

Countermeasure Design

Develop practical countermeasures using visual management, standard work, mistake-proofing, and simple control methods.

A3 Action Planning

Prepare a clear A3 improvement report and implementation action plan for management review.

Learning Approach

The program uses a practical, workshop-based format. Participants work from operational examples and improvement logic rather than theory alone. The emphasis is on making problems visible, using evidence, selecting workable countermeasures, and preparing the next action in a way that supervisors and managers can review.

COURSE OUTLINE

Detailed 5-Day Learning Flow

Each day builds one part of the Champion capability model: foundation, diagnosis, analysis, implementation planning, and sustainment.

Day 1 Foundation of Kaizen

MORNING SESSION

- Program overview and participant introductions.
- Kaizen philosophy, historical context, and relevance to modern manufacturing operations.
- The role of a Kaizen Champion: responsibilities, expected behaviours, and organisational impact.
- Quality, Cost, Delivery (QCD) framework and how improvement links to business performance.
- PDCA cycle as the basic engine for continuous improvement.

AFTERNOON SESSION

- Reactive versus proactive mindset: moving from firefighting to prevention.
- Champion competencies: technical problem solving, facilitation, communication, and follow-through.
- Operational excellence case study and discussion on successful improvement methods.
- PDCA exercise using practical operational challenges.
- Personal goal setting and participant commitment for the program.

Day 2 Baseline and Problem Identification

MORNING SESSION

- The 8 Wastes: overproduction, waiting, transport, processing, inventory, motion, defects, and underutilised talent.
- Baseline metrics and KPI selection, including cycle time, defect rate, downtime, lead time, and labour productivity.
- Assessment methodology for understanding the current state before jumping to solutions.

AFTERNOON SESSION

- Waste identification workshop using practical workplace examples.
- 5S framework: Sort, Set in Order, Shine, Standardise, and Sustain.
- Data collection planning: process boundary, metric definition, owner, timing, and evidence required.

COURSE OUTLINE

Analysis, Countermeasures and Implementation

Day 3**Root Cause Analysis and Solutions****MORNING SESSION**

- 5 Why analysis method for drilling down from symptoms to true causes.
- Fishbone diagram construction using Man, Machine, Method, Material, and Environment thinking.
- 7 Quality Control Tools: Check Sheet, Pareto, Histogram, Run Chart, Scatter Plot, Stratification, and Control Chart.

AFTERNOON SESSION

- Data analysis workshop using baseline information and observed process patterns.
- Countermeasure development: creating specific, testable responses to root causes.
- Implementation plan framework covering owner, timing, resources, success criteria, and follow-up.

Day 4**Implementation and Leadership****MORNING SESSION**

- A3 report development: background, current condition, analysis, countermeasures, plan, and expected results.
- Poka Yoke mistake-proofing and how to prevent errors before they happen.
- Jidoka concept: building quality into the process and responding when abnormalities appear.

AFTERNOON SESSION

- Visual management systems that make status, problems, and targets visible at a glance.
- Standard work documentation: best known method, sequence, timing, and quality criteria.
- Leading change: communicating why, involving staff, training properly, and building early buy-in.
- Pilot and rollout strategy: start small, monitor daily, adjust quickly, then scale.

COURSE OUTLINE

Sustainment and Participant Output

Day 5

Sustainability and Culture

MORNING SESSION

- Sustainability strategy: standard work audits, visual metrics, accountability, and recognition.
- Preventing regression through review routines, quick-fix protocols, and training refreshes.
- Managing resistance by addressing fear, habit, effort, and ownership barriers with empathy.

AFTERNOON SESSION

- KPI tracking and dashboards linked to Quality, Cost, and Delivery.
- Business impact framing: connecting KPI movement, waste reduction, and evidence to management priorities.
- Capstone presentations where participants present their A3 report and receive feedback.
- Implementation action plan review covering next steps, owner rhythm, support needed, and follow-through.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Explain key Kaizen principles and the Champion role.
- Identify waste and define a practical improvement opportunity.
- Analyse problems using structured root cause methods.
- Select suitable countermeasures based on evidence.
- Build a simple KPI tracking structure.
- Present an A3 improvement plan clearly to supervisors or management.
- Support follow-through so improvements are not lost after training.

Expected Participant Output

A structured A3 improvement plan, selected KPI, and practical implementation actions that can be reviewed with the participant's supervisor or management team.